Day 18 - Hilton Falls, Philip Gosling, Restoration

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Toronto section · hike 25 · Hilton Falls Conservation Area

12.3 km / 7.7 mi	~3.5 h	4.3 km new	40 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

Park (P): Reservation system in effect. Hilton Falls Conservation Area: Enter from Campbellville Rd. Google Maps. **Paid: $12 per adult at gate, $10.50 online (+HST); no separate vehicle fee · book ahead** · book/pay online at parkvisit.ca, or at gate (call button if unstaffed); Booking ahead strongly advised (BTC: reservation system in effect); walk-ups only if capacity; CH vehicle membership $165 covers a carload

Navigate: import *day18_hike025.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Hilton Falls Side Trail (3.4 km); Philip Gosling Side Trail (0.7 km); Restoration Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Enter from Campbellville Rd. A reservation system is in effect; Conservation Halton recommends booking online, which secures a spot and can lower the gate fee. Listed park hours are 8:30 a.m. to 7 p.m.
- **Philip Gosling Side Trail:** A short link from the main lot to the Bruce Trail. A trip report notes the reservoir stays hidden behind a ridge along this stretch.

- **Hilton Falls Side Trail:** Leads to the falls, which flow in every season. Stone remains of three 19th-century sawmills sit at the brow, and a small viewing platform is reached by stairs. The rocks below are slippery; keep Zappy back from wet rock.
- **Main trail and the Gap:** The Bruce Trail crosses “The Gap,” an open-pit quarry cut in 1962, on a footbridge with views over the active quarry, farmland and, on clear days, distant skylines.
- **Restoration Side Trail:** A brief spur looking over a closed section of the quarry that is being restored to natural land.
- **Road walking:** Two stretches of the main trail follow a road shoulder; keep Zappy close and walk single file facing traffic.
- **Shared trails:** The park also has mountain-bike single-track, and horses are allowed on its red, purple and yellow trails (not on the Bruce Trail). Watch for bikes and horses where trails meet.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Reservation system in effect. Walk about 100 m to the trail. Head north-east on the blue-blazed Philip Gosling Side Trail.
0.7	0.5	J1: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off behind you.)
1.1	0.7	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Hilton Falls Side Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.6	2.8	J3: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
8.0	5.0	J2: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the main Bruce Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
9.2	5.7	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
9.4	5.9	J4: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Restoration Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
9.6	6.0	J5: End of the Restoration Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
9.7	6.0	J4: Turn right onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
9.8	6.1	Heads-up: The next 0.1 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
11.2	7.0	J2: Junction. Turn left to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-east. (the Hilton Falls Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
11.6	7.2	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Philip Gosling Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
12.3	7.7	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Conservation Halton, Hiking the GTA and georgetownon.ca.